EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Employment and leave

A practical reference for permanent, full-time employees of Aster Vale Technologies. Contractor benefits are governed by the signed engagement, not this handbook.

01 / Scope and authority

People Operations owns this handbook. The People Director approved version 2.0 on 15 December 2025. It replaces version 1.0 for leave beginning on or after 01 January 2026. Local employment obligations and an employee's signed contract take precedence if they provide a different mandatory entitlement. Managers must ask People Operations to resolve exceptions rather than interpret them informally.

02 / Annual leave

Annual leave allowance is 24 working days per calendar year. For a mid-year joiner, People Operations calculates a prorated balance using complete months of service. Up to 5 days of unused annual leave may carry into the following year and must be used by 31 March. The carryover balance is not added permanently to the annual entitlement.

03 / Probation and notice

New employees complete a 90-day probation period. The manager records a review on day 75 and People Operations confirms the outcome before day 90. The standard employee resignation notice period is 30 calendar days, subject to the signed contract. Unused leave cannot automatically replace the notice period.

Document control: AV-HR-001 / approved / fictional company policy. This document is demonstration content, not legal or employment advice.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

Requesting time away

Use the People portal as the system of record. Messages in a team chat are a courtesy notification and do not replace a recorded request.

04 / Planned leave

Submit planned annual leave at least 7 calendar days before the first day away. The line manager should approve or request clarification within 2 business days. The employee names a handover owner and links the current task list. A request remains pending until its status is Approved in the portal; a calendar invitation alone is not approval.

05 / Illness and emergencies

The separate sick leave allowance is 12 working days per calendar year. Notify the line manager before the normal start time where practical and record the absence within 2 business days of returning. People Operations may request supporting information through a private channel. Do not place medical details in a shared project workspace.

06 / Working-day convention

A working day means Monday through Friday excluding holidays in the employee's assigned office calendar. A calendar-day deadline includes weekends. A business-day service target starts on receipt of a complete request. The distinction matters when planning a handover or checking a late submission.

Item	Rule	Record owner
Annual leave	24 working days / year	People Operations
Carryover	Up to 5 days; use by 31 March	People Operations
Sick leave	12 working days / year	People Operations
Planned request	At least 7 calendar days ahead	Employee

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

People policy in practice

Apply the handbook together with the detailed hybrid work, expenses and information security standards. This page explains how those documents fit together.

07 / Hybrid work and equipment

Eligible employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week with manager approval under AV-HR-002. Tuesday and Thursday are the usual collaboration days in the office. The annual home-office equipment allowance is INR 5000 under AV-FIN-001; it is reimbursement against approved receipts, not an automatic salary payment. Remote work does not change the leave balance.

08 / Example: joining and taking leave

A new employee joining on 01 July has 6 complete months remaining in the calendar year. At 24 days per year, the illustrative prorated annual leave balance is 12 days. People Operations confirms the actual balance in the portal. An employee carrying 4 unused days into 2027 must use those carried days by 31 March 2027.

09 / Questions and policy changes

Ask People Operations through the People portal for balance corrections or contractual questions. The handbook does not define a parental leave entitlement; People Operations must provide the applicable separate policy. Do not infer an entitlement from this document's silence. Changes require a document revision, effective date and recorded approval.

Reference	Subject	Use it for
AV-HR-002	Hybrid work	Attendance and exceptions
AV-FIN-001	Travel and expenses	Receipts and approval limits
AV-SEC-001	Information security	Access and incident reporting